

Dinosaur tracks

About 190 million years ago, a large predatory dinosaur was walking along the shore of a river when it suddenly stopped in its tracks. It turned, and then broke into a run, perhaps in a dash for prey. How do we know this? Because its footprints became fossilized. Dinosaur tracks can give us an amazing glimpse into the behavior of the animals that left them.

▲ THIS PRINT is one of about 2,000 that were found at Dinosaur State Park in Connecticut. No remains of the dinosaurs were found, but scientists think they may have been *Dilophosaurus* or something similar. The animals seem to have been crossing an ancient mudflat.

This set of tracks was found in Spain. The prints are nearly 3 ft (1 m) apart, suggesting a big animal made them. The shape of the foot indicates it was a theropod (a meat-eater).